For Cart Ni Isko / Tindahan ni Isko, I recommend designing delivery around one important rule:

Do not book or charge for a Lalamove delivery until the order is actually ready for dispatch. Since your store accepts pre-orders without a definite release date, calculating delivery fees too early can cause inaccurate charges, expired delivery arrangements, and disputes with customers.

Your system should separate the product order, production readiness, delivery fee calculation, and courier dispatch into distinct stages. This lets customers place pre-orders without the store promising a release date it cannot guarantee.

1. Recommended delivery logic

There are two different delivery scenarios your system needs to handle.

Scenario A — In-stock online order

Ready for delivery

The product is available and can be prepared for dispatch within the store's normal processing time.

Customer checks out and provides a delivery address.

The system calculates an estimated delivery fee.

The store confirms the order and prepares the items.

Once packed, the store obtains a current Lalamove quote.

The order is dispatched after payment and delivery details are confirmed.

Scenario B — Pre-order requiring production

Release date unconfirmed

The product is not yet ready, and the store cannot guarantee when production will finish.

Customer checks out and places the pre-order.

The system records the delivery address and preferred delivery method.

The order remains in the production queue until the item is ready.

The system does not create a Lalamove booking yet.

Once the order is ready, the store obtains a fresh Lalamove quote and requests any necessary additional payment or confirms the final delivery charge.

The store dispatches the order only after the final delivery arrangements are accepted.

My recommendation: Apply the same rule to every pre-order, even when the item is expected to be released soon. The absence of a definite release date means the delivery booking should remain deferred.

2. How checkout and delivery payment should work

The key decision is whether the customer pays for the products and delivery together at checkout, or pays for delivery later.

For your system, I recommend collecting the product payment at checkout and calculating the actual delivery fee only when the pre-order is ready, subject to the store's refund and payment policies.

Lalamove's Philippine terms state that charges may fluctuate based on demand and other factors, and that cancellation can incur a fee. This makes it risky to book or prepay for a delivery before you know when the product will be ready.
Lalamove Philippines

Recommended checkout calculation

Suppose a customer orders a pre-order item worth ₱1,200.

Customer checkout — pre-order

Product subtotal

₱1,200.00

Discount

− ₱0.00

Delivery fee

Final quote pending item readiness

Not yet calculated

Pay now

Product payment only

₱1,200.00

Delivery fee will be calculated when your order is ready for dispatch. You will be notified of the final fee and payment instructions before delivery is booked.

The checkout must clearly disclose that delivery is excluded from the amount due now. The customer should explicitly accept this arrangement before placing the order.

When the item is ready

Assume Lalamove quotes ₱180 for the actual delivery.

Final delivery payment

Product payment already made

₱1,200.00

Final Lalamove delivery charge

₱180.00

Total order cost

₱1,380.00

Additional payment due

₱180.00

These amounts are illustrative, not actual Lalamove rates.

Once the customer pays the additional fee, the store can proceed with the booking. If the customer declines the revised fee, the system should follow a disclosed policy for alternative delivery, pickup, or cancellation and any applicable refund.

3. Delivery fee calculation formula

Your system should use separate calculations for the amount payable now and the total order cost.

Pay Now

=Product Subtotal

−Discounts+Other Due Charges

Final Total=Pay Now+Final Delivery Fee
Balance Due=Final Total−Payments Received

For a pre-order, the delivery fee should be null or a clearly identified pending amount—not ₱0 represented as free delivery.

For an in-stock order, you can calculate a live quote during checkout if your integration supports it. However, if the actual delivery fee can change before booking, the system should disclose whether the displayed amount is an estimate or a confirmed charge.

The final delivery amount should come from the actual Lalamove quote and any applicable agreed charges, not from a hardcoded price-per-kilometer formula. Lalamove's terms also describe additional charges such as tolls and demand-related fees.
Lalamove Philippines

4. Suggested order and delivery status flow

Keep production status separate from delivery status. An order can be in production without having a courier booking, and a courier should only be assigned after the item is ready.

1. Order placed

Product payment confirmed; delivery fee pending

2. Awaiting Production → In Production

No courier booking; no release date promised

3. Preparing

Item is ready for final packing and dispatch preparation

4. Delivery fee confirmation

Obtain fresh Lalamove quote and notify customer

5. Awaiting Delivery Payment

Wait for the customer to pay or confirm the agreed payment method

6. Ready for Dispatch → Out for Delivery

Book Lalamove, record booking details, and hand over the parcel

7. Complete

Delivery completion is verified

If the store allows customers to pay for delivery on receipt, you can support that as a separate payment arrangement—but do not assume Lalamove supports a particular collection or payment-on-delivery method for your integration without verifying it.

5. What if the delivery quote changes?

Build these scenarios into your business logic from the beginning.

Situation	Recommended behavior
Quote increases before booking	Notify customer and request approval/payment for the difference.
Quote decreases before booking	Charge the lower amount or refund/credit any excess already collected.
No Lalamove driver is available	Keep the order ready for dispatch and retry or offer an alternative.

Customer does not pay the delivery fee

Keep the order on hold and send reminders according to a defined policy.

Customer changes the delivery address

Obtain a new quote and reconfirm the amount.

Customer cancels before booking

Apply the published cancellation and refund policy.

Courier booking is cancelled or incurs extra fees

Record the actual charge, determine responsibility under store policy, and obtain customer approval where required.

Importantly, do not automatically charge the customer for every courier price increase or failed booking. Make the applicable charges and cancellation terms clear before checkout.

6. What your database and Laravel backend should track

At minimum, maintain separate fields for order payment and delivery payment.

Field

Purpose

order_type

Online or Onsite

fulfillment_method

Store Pickup or Courier

production_status

Awaiting Production, In Production, Ready, etc.

delivery_status

Not Required, Pending Quote, Awaiting Payment, Ready for Dispatch, Out for Delivery, Delivered

delivery_fee_estimate

Optional early estimate

delivery_fee_final

Final confirmed courier fee

delivery_quote_reference

Reference to the quote, if provided

delivery_quote_expires_at

Expiration, if provided

delivery_payment_status

Not Due, Pending, Paid, Refunded

delivery_payment_amount

Amount collected specifically for delivery

lalamove_booking_reference

Courier booking identifier

delivery_address_snapshot

Address used for the confirmed quote

delivery_booked_at

Actual booking timestamp

Use a separate payment transaction record for each payment rather than overwriting the original product payment. This makes refunds, reconciliation, and audit trails easier.

Implementation rule

The backend—not the frontend—should control when quotes are requested and bookings are allowed. Before booking, validate that:

The items are ready and packed.

The address and parcel information are accurate.

The quote is still valid, if the provider supplies an expiry.

The required delivery payment has been confirmed.

No active booking already exists for the same dispatch.

Your React frontend should display the order and payment states, while Laravel enforces these rules and coordinates with the courier integration.

7. An alternative if you want one checkout payment

If you strongly prefer customers to pay one total amount upfront, you have two alternatives:

Store-subsidized delivery: Charge a fixed delivery price and let the store absorb any difference between that price and the eventual courier charge.

Estimated delivery fee: Collect an estimate upfront, then reconcile the actual fee when the order is ready. This requires a clearly disclosed additional-payment or refund process.

For a store that accepts pre-orders with no definite release date, I would avoid the second option unless the payment gateway and refund workflow are reliable. The customer may be waiting weeks or months, and a delivery fee collected that far in advance may no longer reflect the actual cost.

My final recommendation: For pre-orders, charge for the products at checkout, show delivery as “To be calculated when ready,” and collect the final delivery fee before booking Lalamove. For in-stock orders, offer a live delivery estimate at checkout and confirm the actual charge before dispatch. This keeps your customer-facing checkout honest while preventing the store from paying for unnecessary bookings or absorbing unpredictable delivery costs.